

Dibya Deepta Mishra

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PhD economist and MS computer scientist researching the incentives, measurement, and economic effects of advanced AI. Experienced in causal inference, structural modeling, and translating quantitative evidence for decision makers.

AI POLICY AND RESEARCH

SPAR Research Fellow, The Economic Value of AI Capability Gains (voluntary) 2026–present

- Study how gains in model capability translate into productivity and economic value, accounting for adoption thresholds, verification costs, and complementary bottlenecks.

Dynamic Competition and Frontier AI Model Release (work in progress) 2026

- Developing an economic model of firms' release timing, capability gains, safety investment, and competition; examining how safety requirements could change release incentives.

You Can't Reward What You Can't See (AlignmentxEcon blog series, Part 1) 2026

- Applied principal–agent theory to AI oversight, including the risk that optimizing against a monitor can weaken the information it provides.

AI Agent Swarms and Collective Risk (joint work in progress) 2026

- Analyzing how coordinated less-capable agents share procedures, amplify capability, and propagate failures; examining independent verification before wider adoption.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cornerstone Research | Associate | Chicago, IL Jan 2025–Sep 2026

- Managed teams of 3–5 analysts processing healthcare claims and proprietary technology-platform datasets with 1M+ records; reviewed data quality, reproducible code, and quantitative work supporting expert testimony.
- Developed causal and structural analyses to test opposing experts' economic theories, identification assumptions, and causal claims; presented methods and limitations to the testifying expert and senior teams.
- Assessed generative AI benchmark reliability and robustness, translating technical findings into clear presentations for expert teams.

Amazon Retail Pricing | Economist Intern | Seattle, WA May–Aug 2023

- Built demand and elasticity models on 1M+ retail observations using product-text language model embeddings; improved demand prediction by 5% over baseline and connected estimates to pricing optimization.

Indian School of Business | Research Associate | Hyderabad, India Sep 2017–Apr 2019

- Evaluated market and policy interventions using causal inference on large administrative and survey datasets; coauthored a case study on healthcare incentives.

HSBC | Business and Regulatory Risk Research | Mumbai, India May 2014–Mar 2015

- Analyzed regulatory and macroeconomic developments and presented risk assessments to senior management.

SELECTED POLICY AND EMPIRICAL RESEARCH

- Hospital Choice and Quality: Combined machine learning measures of risk-adjusted hospital quality with a structural choice model; simulated information and hospital participation policies in Indian public insurance.
- Beyond a Free Lunch (with T. Devi, A. Keskar, R. Sethi; R&R, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization): Evaluated how out-of-school nutrition transfers affected girls' schooling and later health in India.
- Pennies for Pads (under review): Evaluated a staggered policy rollout using doubly robust difference in differences and linked survey, administrative, and geospatial data for nearly 500,000 women.
- PNAS (2026): Coauthored meta-study of human–AI teams assessing research reproducibility.

EDUCATION

Rice University, PhD Economics (industrial organization and structural econometrics), 2024 | Georgia Tech, MS Computer Science (machine learning and AI), 2024

LSE, MSc Econometrics, 2017 | IIM Calcutta, MBA, 2014 | IIT Jodhpur, BTech Electrical Engineering, 2012

Methods: structural models, causal inference, AI evaluation; Python, R, Stata, SQL, PyTorch.

Awards: Inlaks Scholar, Charkap Scholarship, Viterbi India Fellow, NTSE Scholar.